

by stage, placing highest priority stage at the top

1. Prioritize the opportunities you are going to work on first by stage, amount, and close date
1. Ensure "Next Steps," "Next Step Date," and "Next Steps Owner" are current with actionable and informative information that helps guide you on how to move the opportunity through the pipeline
1. If a potential future opportunity that requires an action is greater than 30 days out, make sure this is detailed in the next steps field
1. Once opportunities in the stages Discovery through Awaiting Signature are updated, begin working on Pending Acceptance. Continue to prioritize with the same criteria as above.

### Pipeline Generation

- In weekly communication with your direct management review the health of your pipeline and update records as needed in real-time. You should know at all times what your pipeline multiplier is and if you need to create more pipeline to have a successful month and quarter. Refer to your team's Pipeline Generation checklist documents and the associated SFDC reports associated with keeping activity up to date.

### Commercial Sales Stages Activities and Exit Criteria

- Pipeline management is key to predictable, scalable revenue attainment and can make the difference between simply hitting your number and overachieving. Proper sales pipeline management helps you allocate your time correctly, increase deal velocity, and increase total deal volume, size, and revenue through accurate forecasting practices.
- A well-managed sales pipeline requires a clear process with defined activities and exit criteria that serve as a roadmap to getting a deal from discovery to closed won (or qualified out quickly). The following process is specific to the Commercial Sales team and will ensure you have a clean pipeline and accurate forecast.
- Detailed Exit Stage Criteria Google Sheet
- Exit Criteria at a Glance

- Please read through the Commercial Sales Opportunity Stages handbook page for more information.

### Web Direct Oppty Management in Salesforce

- Find the report view for all CFQ "current fiscal quarter" Web Direct purchases in your territory "SMBWeb Directs CFQname":
- 1. Check that there are no open opportunities that could have been a duplicate by viewing the opportunities listed under the Account
- 1. If not a duplicate, place the main contact in the opportunity on the outreach sequence "SMBWeb Direct Outreach" - by: Madeline Hennessy
- 1. Dependent on the opportunity and company if personal outreach is preferred, you must log your activity and have a next step date to follow up on your activity

### Licensing/Subscription Management

> Note: if you need access to a system, open an Access Request

## GitLab Trials & Subscription Management

- Access the CustomersDot to provide changes to a user, group, or subscription.

## Troubleshooting & How-To Resources for Licensing & Subscription Management

Detailed instructions on how to handle problems with licenses and subscriptions can be found in these instructions and resources.

## Quotes | Sales Order Processing

More information about sales order processing can be found in the Business Ops handbook section.

## Mid Market Account Executive

Midmarket Account Executives are the primary point of contact between prospective and existing customers of GitLab within a space defined as mid-market, which currently works with companies that employ between 100 to 1,999 employees. These GitLab team members manage the spectrum of project sizes, ranging from small fast growing teams in smaller agile organizations to complex enterprise projects advising on the journey with GitLab to achieve specific business outcomes.

Mid-Market AEs work closely in tandem with the business development team and sales management to manage a broad book of business spread over a large opportunity value range and focus on exceeding client expectations.

## Mid Market Roles

1. New Logo AE: These AEs work on the Base Accounts that are not currently customers of GitLab. Once the customer has signed its first contract, the customer is transitioned to the SMB, MM, or ENT segment depending on the size of the customers.
1. MM Key Accounts Named AE (MMKAN): These AEs work on current customers that have been deemed to be high spending (high CARR) or have the potential to be high spending (high LAM). To be successful the MMKAN AE must expand their accounts more than the standard expansion rate for their named list of accounts. The named list for each MMKAN AE will grow through the fiscal year as the MMKAFO AE wins new high potential customers.
1. MM Territory AE: These AEs work geographic regions of accounts that have not been vetted to be New Logo AE or MM Key Account named AE. The role sells to both prospects and current accounts.

"MM Key Accounts" can be used to refer to MM Key Accounts First Order and MM Key Accounts Named collectively. MM Key Accounts are the sub-set of MM accounts with a higher LAM and potential LAM.

## Core Responsibilities

- Own your set of accounts - build & execute your plan.
- Manage book of business: new business, expansion, renewals.

- Collaborate with Sales Development channel for handover of inbound qualified opportunities to progress to closure.
- Execute outbound campaigns.

#### New Business

- Work Initial Qualification Meetings IQM's from SDR Team
- Accept Sales Accepted Opportunities according to SAO Criteria
- Nurture and help prospects during their Trial evaluation after Accepting Opportunities
- Push to Webdirect or help with the Sales Order Process

#### Selecting Target Accounts for marketing

- Log into Datafox or Sales Navigator
- Input your territory criteria
- Establish a list of accounts and sort by Company Head Count
- Search for keywords like DevOps
- Look into each account to see if they are actually yours
- Look into each employee that is either an engineer or technology professionals
- Add that company name to your list
- If not enough companies through this process continue below:
- Look for the intersection of revenue and vertical in Datafox
- Look at the account in SFDC to see if CE User
- Filter using signals if using Datafox
- Assess if they have had recent funding announcements
- Once selected add the company name, city, and zip code to your sheet

#### Customer Journey

- Inbound Queue Management
- Licensing/Subscription Management
- Troubleshooting Resource for Licensing/Subscription Management
- Quotes / Sales Order Processing
- Customer Health Check Process
- Gainsight Data in SFDC Definitions

#### Account Ownership Rules of Engagement for Commercial Sales updated 2022-09-22

The Commercial Sales Team follows the Account Ownership Rules of Engagement  
This section provides step by step clarity on how to follow the ROE.

#### Process to follow

Account will be organized into the following two categories:

1. Accounts who were customers before February 1st of the fiscal year
1. Accounts who became customers on or after February 1st of the fiscal year

Accounts who became customers before February 1st of the fiscal year will follow this process

It is the responsibility of the Account Executive who owns the account to qualify how many employees the account has prior to February 1st.

Accounts who have less than 100 employees on or before February 1st will be owned by SMB for the fiscal year

Accounts who have 100 or more employees on or before February 1st will be owned by Mid Market for the fiscal year

- As an Account Executive, if you qualify an account and are unsure of the rules of engagement by the number of employees or corporate address, you should screenshot the data you are reviewing, post it on the account in chatter and edit Account Rank Notes. Tag your Area Sales Manager when research is complete for further review by @ mentioning them. If the ASM has reviewed the data provided by the Account Executive as well as doing their own due diligence and is unsure of the rules of engagement, they should screenshot their research, post it on the account in chatter and tag the Regional Director for review by @ mentioning them. Finally, if a Regional Director is unsure of the rules of engagement after reviewing the data provided and doing their own due diligence, they should screenshot their research, post it on the account in chatter and tag the Regional Vice President for review and final decision. All final decisions for Commercial account and opportunity ownership are up to the sole discretion of the Regional Vice President of the Commercial Division.

Accounts who became customers on or after February 1st of the fiscal year

Accounts will be separated into the following categories

1. Sales Assisted First Order

1. Web Direct First Order

For sales assisted first orders, it is the responsibility of the account executive who conducts the initial discovery with the prospect to research and qualify the number of employees and headquarter location for the account.

If the account has less than 100 employees the account will be managed by SMB for the remainder of the fiscal year

If the account 100 employees or greater the account will be managed by Mid Market for the remainder of the fiscal year

If the account has greater than 500 employees or greater than 100 LAM dev please see the Rules of Engagement Between MMKAFO and Mid-Market Territory for FY '23 for proper lead routing

For web direct first orders we understand there may be a degree of differentiation of actual employee count versus what our systems capture based on the tools utilized to enrich data. It is the responsibility of the Account Executive who owns the first order to identify the correct number of employees after the web direct first order and ensure that the employee count is not "wholly wrong". Wholly wrong is used only for accounts that upon initial assignment are assigned by automation i.e. no team member reviewed them at first transaction.

Wholly wrong is defined as the following

Mid Market owned accounts with less than 80 employees

SMB owned accounts with greater than 120 employees

If an account is wholly wrong, it is the responsibility of the account owner to chatter @sales-support to reassign the first order and the account to the correct segment.

If an account is not wholly wrong but above or below the segment line (respectively) is it the responsibility of the account owner to chatter @sales-support to flag the account to move to the appropriate segment at the beginning of the following fiscal year.

All accounts that are not researched or identified as being assigned to the wrong segment will be reassigned.

If the AE qualifies this and then keeps it, this can lead to disciplinary action.

As part of the qualification process it is expected to qualify the location of company headquarters and employee count so we can best support the customer. It is not acceptable to qualify location and employee count in a manner that jeopardizes the customer experience. If you are unsure, always tag your manager in chatter to review the data before involving the customer.

## Rules of Engagement Between MMKAFO and Mid-Market Territory for FY '23

### Fiscal Year 2023 Account Moves

For all accounts that are in Salesforce.com as of February 24, 2022 the Mid-Market Key Accounts First Order team will own all accounts that are:

1. Segmented to Mid-Market NORAM or EMEA

1. Marked as "First Order Available" in Salesforce  
AND

1. Have a full time employee count of 500 employees or greater as marked in the "Account Demographic Max Family Employees" field under Account Demographics in SFDC.

OR

1. Have a potential user count of 100 users or more as measured by the LAM Dev Count Field.

To avoid confusion the logic is [1 AND 2 AND (3 OR 4)].

Note: If an AE suspects that the employee count or potential user count is not accurate in our data sources, it is the AEs responsibility to uncover the employee count and potential user count during the discovery phase. If an account is identified to belong to either territory or First Order and the other party continues to work the lead without doing proper due diligence, the account will be reassigned to the appropriate party.

### New Accounts to Salesforce.com after Feb 24, 2022

1. For all inbound MQLs for which an account does not yet exist in Salesforce.com, the routing of that lead and account will be based exclusively on employee count.

- If the account has 500+ employees it will be routed to the MMKAFO team

- If the account has less than 500 employees it will be routed to the Mid-Market Territory team

1. MMKAFO AEs are able to go outbound to accounts that are not yet in Salesforce.com that fit the criteria in the Mid Market Key Accounts definition:

- Mid-Market accounts that have either 500+ employees OR 100 potential users as defined by LinkedIn Engineering + IT personnel count.

1. MMKAFO AEs are able to create the outbound accounts in SFDC that fit the above criteria, and

ask Sales Operations to move the account into their name.

- Note: If it is found out that an AE asks for an account to be deduplicated in order to work said account, disciplinary action will be taken.

### Account Moves Throughout Fiscal Year 2023

1. If an MMKAFO AE finds out through discovery that a sub 500 employee account segmented to First Order in reality has less than 100 potential users, they should immediately ask for the account to be moved to Territory.

1. If a "First Order Available" account is segmented to Territory, and the Territory AE finds out through discovery that the account actually has more than 500 employees, they should immediately ask for the account to be moved to First Order.

1. The automation for new accounts in the system means accounts with under 500 employees but over 100 potential users will be routed to territory and left there unless they have no activity at the quarter change over.

1. If it is found out that an AE intentionally ignores rules number 1 or 2 more than twice in a fiscal year disciplinary action is likely to be taken.

### Co-Selling

Co-selling is the responsibility of both the Account Executive and their Area Sales Manager to join sales calls together. This is to ensure the best client/prospect experience, along with jointly finding the highest potential within that account.

Area Sales Managers have an expectation to log a minimum of 5 co-selling calls per rolling 7 days, although we are aiming to achieve closer to 10-12 calls over a rolling 7 days.

### Co-Selling Roles when working with your ASM

- Primary Seller: Consider this role as the main pitch person. You are directing the conversation, sharing the deck and taking live notes and adding value, while also keeping on track with the agenda decided upon.

- Co-Seller: This individual is responsible for raw notes in Salesforce, time management, and digging into comments to identify areas where we should be finding additional information. The Co-pilot should be digging into levels and amounts of pain when the Pilot moves on without capturing this.

For additional information please visit this reinforcement module

### Working with Channel Partners

The GitLab partner network is ready to work with GitLab Account Executive's in order to extend the customer selling and services capacity offered by Commercial Sales. Channel's approach to this is called Partner Co-selling and working with Partners involves building a simple, clear, mutual customer opportunity plan establishing "who will do what, when?".

### What are the key benefits from working with partners?

- AEs Working with Partners for Increased Customer Value & Net ARR

- Extended reach and capabilities via Partner sales and services capacity and reach via GitLab-trained Partner AE's, SA's, Engineers, and often a GitLab channel manager to coordinate/assist.

- Accelerated reach to new customer logos "<b>Land</b>": Partners are beginning to bring GitLab

new logo opportunities via mining their customer base. In many cases, Partners already have a "trusted Partner status" with their customers, which also serves to accelerate new logo engagements.

- Increased customer "<b>Expand</b>" success: In many cases, Partners will sell and deliver the key services called for to ensure customers get the maximum value from their GitLab technology investment and drive stage advance along with user growth.
- Deployment and related services: For faster delivery and increased capacity, AEs are turning to Partners to sell and deliver these services, also CSM-like customer success services.
- In the case of OPEN partners via distributors, dramatic reduction in the admin steps associated with quote-to-order process.

How do AEs work with partners for increased customer value & Net ARR?

GitLab has a mature Partner network with good coverage of GitLab-trained Sales and Technical resources. There are a few ways in which AEs will work with a customer including a Partner.

- Approved Partner GitLab Deal Registrations As these are received in your territory, in most cases you will be contacted by a GitLab channel team member to arrange a co-selling kickoff call to develop a simple Partner co-selling plan to share with the Partner. GitLab Channel Managers do not proactively manage all OPEN Partners. AEs can always request Channel Manager support for a Deal Registration by slacking channel-sales or available contacts.
- If you find yourselves thinking 1. "a Partner SA could execute on this customer-requested SA task", or 2. AEs have customers that could benefit from a "Partner services attach engagement", reach out on slack channel-sales with a Partner engagement request, if possible with a link to the related account or opportunity. A member of the channel team will promptly reach out to learn more about the request, and connect you with a Partner that is pre-qualified to promptly and properly execute on the task at hand, and keep you updated along the way.
- AEs should lead planning and execution of the joint opportunity/customer pursuit with alignment and support of the partner and GitLab Channel Manager. The plan should be tracked in SFDC with tasks and action items. Partners should always get an email confirmation of any tasks assigned to them (via AE or Channel Mgr).
- Channel Managers will engage with AE's in the following ways:
  - When a new deal registration arrives in the AE's pipeline
  - To review 2-3 Partners for the AE to work with for AE-selected joint customer success motions:
    - The Channel Manager will bring the possibilities forward during this call
    - 2 examples of working with Partners are featured in this LevelUp
    - AEs should share their thoughts about prioritizing which Partner activities would be best for which of their customers
- In the case of Open partners via distributions, when the opportunity is ready, AE's email [partnersupport@gitlab.com](mailto:partnersupport@gitlab.com) with the link to the opportunity requesting quote-to-order support (chatter alias coming soon)

Resources to learn more about teaming with Channel Partners?

- If this is a first time for an AE, we recommend watching the available training delivered. This Levelup video starts with a basic understanding of the Channel Partner landscape.
- LevelUp video on Maximizing Value of Partners in a Deal specifically for AE's to learn more about co-selling success.
- Learn more about Partner co-selling best practices, how Partners can help build out key

elements of an AE's R7 & Command Plans and much more in the Channel Sales Handbook.

- Slack channel-sales or reach out to your Channel Account Manager with any questions or requests for assistance. The channel is closely monitored by several members of the channel team who are here to help AE's succeed in co-selling in any way we can.
- List of GitLab-trained OPEN and SELECT channel partners
- Channel Partner Finder Here

## New Logo Team

The New Logo Team is a specialized sales team within GitLab's High Velocity Sales & New Logo organization focused on closing first-order deals in MM & ENT accounts.

After the first transaction is closed by the New Logo team, the New Logo AEs are responsible to kickstart the handover process. Below are the responsibilities of the New Logo team and the Mid-Market Key Account Named team.

### When to Pass an Account Mid-Market or Enterprise

New Logo AEs will own an account until an account becomes a paid customer. Once this happens, the account will graduate into their respective segment (SMB, MM, or ENT).

## Handover Process

### New Logo AE Responsibilities

Please refer to the New Logo Team Playbook for additional information about the role and responsibilities.

1. Ensure the opportunity is marked as 'Closed-Won'.

1. Ensure the customer has a working license.

1. Log an activity (naming convention: [NL AE NAME] NL Account Summary for Handoff) on the account level detailing the following:

- Why the account chose GitLab (use case)
- The expected NetARR to be sold in the next 12 months
- Estimated timeframe of the next purchase
- Why you believe b and c to be the case

1. Work with the Named or Territory AE, the CSM (if known), and the customer to set up a handoff call

- New Logo AE should take the lead on scheduling this call

- Note : Should the NL Rep and Named or Territory AE agree ahead of time that an email introduction will suffice, then the team can bypass the handoff call.

1. If the initial amount AND the potential of the next opportunity are less than a combined NetARR of \$10,000, or the inheriting AE agrees, a handoff email can be used.

1. Ensure all material like custom decks are added into a dedicated customer sub-folder in the Customers & Prospects drive.

- Create a sub-folder in one of the folders labeled A-Z based on the first letter of the customer account name. (Example: Acme Inc. would go in the folder labeled "A")

- Add all customer facing or internal documents related to that customer into the folder.

This way the entire Account Team will be able to view all related content.

1. For Web Directs without prior engagement : There will be no handover as the FO AE has not had any engagement.



## Digital Sales Room

A Digital Sales Room is a secure, personalized webpage where AEs can share curated content, collaborate with prospects, and track buyer engagement throughout the sales process. It centralizes all sales materials, presentations, and communications in one branded space, eliminating scattered emails and creating a seamless buyer experience.

### 1. Digital Rooms - Highspot Overview Training

#### 1. Digital Rooms 101

#### 1. Engage Buyers with Digital Rooms

## Named/Territory AE Responsibilities

### 1. Work with the New Logo AE, CSM, and customer to schedule a handoff call (or email).

- The goal should be to have two-way communication with the customer within one week of the initial close.

- If an email is used, the Named or Territory AE should respond at their earliest convenience to introduce themselves as the new primary point of contact

### 1. Look at the account activities for the activity logged by the FO AE.

### 1. Based on the above notes, open a growth opportunity if scheduled before the first renewal date

### 1. Read through all notes tagged (ii), the custom pitch deck, and the command plan to gain an understanding of the account and its potential.

### 1. Engage the CSM on strategic accounts and get them engaged asap

### 1. For Web Directs: It is the responsibility of the Named/Territory AE to reach out to the new customer.

## Process to Move Accounts From Base to Named/Territory

Please refer to the Go-To-Market Rules of Engagement page for additional information about account graduation for the New Logo Team.

## When to Consider Involving a Named or Territory AE Before the Initial Deal is Done

### 1. There may be situations where it is beneficial to either GitLab, the Prospect, or both to introduce the Named or Territory AE before the initial deal closes. These situations include, but are not limited to:

- Extra support is needed for a strategic account.
- A CSM may need to be engaged before the initial contract is signed.
- An onsite meeting may need to happen and the Named/Territory AE is in a better geographical location to handle it.
- The customer has asked to be introduced to who will handle their account after the initial contract is signed.

## General Guidelines to Follow When Making this Consideration

### 1. It is always the decision of the New Logo AE to determine if an introduction should be made pre-contract signature, but there are some general best practices to follow if an introduction is to be made.

- Ideally, pre-contract introductions would be limited to higher LAM accounts, so this does

not become a scale issue.

- >99 LAMDev for Key Accounts

- >49 LAMDev for Territory Accounts

- In an effort to not waste Named/Territory AEs time, an introduction should not be made unless there is a very high close percentage. Therefore, an introduction is best if made when the opportunity is in stage 5 or 6.

1. Named/Territory AEs and New Logo AEs should meet often (every other week on average) to identify accounts where a pre-contract introduction would make sense.

## Commercial Leadership Development Pilot Program

This pilot program is for Commercial team members interested in learning more about Sales management and building foundational leadership skills.

This program is designed to give team members:

1. Exposure to leadership topics and development of foundational leadership skills
1. Leadership frameworks that they can modify and apply to their teams
1. Experience with the expectations of a sales leader and how that differs from an individual contributor role
1. Opportunity to network with peers and other cross functional stakeholders

The program will run for a total of 8 weeks; each week focusing on a new topic. See the proposed topics by week for the pilot program:

| Week | Topic | Description |
|------|-------|-------------|
|------|-------|-------------|

|       |       |       |
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|   |                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|---|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Leading People                          | Primary differences between being an individual contributor and a leader, establishing a V2MOM for your newly created team, building an inclusive culture, situational leadership, coaching model, establishing expectations for success and the cadence of events to drive consistent results on a daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly and annual basis |
| 2 | Running Effective 1 on 1s               | Core components for every meeting, how to capture and provide feedback from activities during the week, building consistency in performance through consistent accountability in one on one.                                                                                                                                                           |
| 3 | A Leaders Responsibility on Sales Calls | Structure of an effective pre-call meeting, what roles a leader should focus on during the sales call, expected follow up for coaching and delivering results                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 4 | Running Effective Team Meetings         | Key components to a great team meeting - recognition, training, results, pipeline creation and current events. How to structure a meeting to bring energy and ensure AEs leave with clear expectations for the week ahead                                                                                                                              |
| 5 | Coaching and Providing Feedback         | Utilizing different coaching frameworks based on situational need - GROW, SBI, Skill/Will Coaching Model. An HR partner's perspective on key professional items that may arise and how to handle them                                                                                                                                                  |
| 6 | Forecasting & Managing Metrics          | Understanding what leading and lagging indicators to measure. Implementing programs based on the trends identified in metrics to ensure consistent, positive results. Learning how to forecast effectively and the role Red/Green plays in being a great coach and manager                                                                             |
| 7 | Recruiting and Interviewing             | How Diversity, Inclusion and Belonging is essential to building a world class team. A recruiter's point of view on how to attract top talent. Review and discuss our Commercial interview methodology. Discuss what questions and activities ensure                                                                                                    |

our interview process is inclusive and legal |  
| 8 |Components of an Effective Pipe Generation Campaign| Review the primary reasons consistent pipe gen campaigns are needed for sustainable growth. Key components of an effective pipeline campaign. How to launch, reinforce, measure and recognize for effective results. |

### Expectations of Participants

- Time Commitment: A total of ~40 hours of dedicated time during the quarter between synchronous meetings and asynchronous work.

The GitLab Commercial department expects all Team members to uphold the highest standards of moral and ethical behavior in harmony with GitLab's CREDIT values. Engaging or promoting activities that are inconsistent with GitLab's values is not acceptable. It is expected that Team members who are enrolled will uphold both stated and inferred values of working at GitLab. Items include but are not limited to:

- Good collaboration with other team members
- Assuming positive intent
- Continuing to deliver results in the team member's current position
- Being inclusive during class discussions, accepting alternate views as alternate, not right or wrong, to foster belonging for other team members

Additionally, it is our expectation that if participating in the program, team members will make their best effort to attend meetings and learning activities. If they are unable to attend, participants should give the facilitator as much advance notice as possible. If participants are not present in the course, they will be removed from the program.

### Who is eligible to participate?

Any Commercial team member that is in good performance standing (not currently on a performance or behavioral warning) and has been in their current role for over 3 months. We will be selecting 12 participants for this first cohort. It is our intention that this program continue after the first pilot program to continue to give Commercial team members a chance to grow their skills.

### Other Related Pages

- Commercial Sales - Customer Success
- Territories

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## SECTION: sales/commercial/high\_velocity\_sales\_first\_orders.md

### HVS-FO Sales Team Structure

The HVS-FO Sales Team is comprised of these 3 sets of teams:

- SMB Advocate Teams, covering global SMB accounts
- New Logo Team, covering Base prospect accounts and Web Direct Mid-Market and Large inbound First Orders

- SMB Renewals Teams, covering global SMB renewals

## SMB Sales Model

- FY26 Global Digital SMB Kick-Off deck
- FY26 Global Digital SMB Segment Lines
- Abbreviations
  - SMB: Small and Medium-sized Business
  - cARR: Contracted Annual Recurring Revenue

All members of the Sales, Support, Billing and Deal Desk teams should familiarize themselves with the Global Digital SMB Model.

The model leverages team-level account alignment so SMB customers have a team of SMB Advocates to assist them. Every SMB Advocate on the team is equipped to work with any SMB customer as the sales point of contact.

The threshold for Global Digital SMB Accounts is <\$30k cARR, <101 employees, and excludes Japan.

## Account and Opportunity Ownership

Vision: SMB Accounts will not be owned individually, but by the entire team. This is meant to ensure that SMB customers are supported at the right time, in a scalable way. Each SMB Advocate will have a shared responsibility for collaborating in a customer-centric manner to provide a best-in-class experience to each SMB customer.

## Accounts

- All AMER SMB Accounts are owned by the AMER SMB Sales User.
- All APJ SMB Accounts are owned by the APJ SMB Sales User.
- All EMEA SMB Accounts are owned by the EMEA SMB Sales User.
- Note that in SMB only, EMEA & APJ are considered one territory.

## Opportunities

- All AMER SMB Opportunities are owned by the AMER SMB Sales User.
- All APJ SMB Opportunities are owned by the APJ SMB Sales User.
- All EMEA SMB Opportunities are owned by the EMEA SMB Sales User.

Advocate owned opportunities will routinely be updated by SMB Ops to the SMB Sales User

## High Value Accounts

Some Global Digital SMB Accounts are considered to be High Value Accounts. These accounts, whilst owned by an SMB Sales User, will be managed in a 1:1 relationship between the SMB Advocate and the customer, via Cases.

You can use the criteria below to help determine whether an SMB account is a High Value Account or not.

- License growth potential
- Department expansion opportunities
- Ultimate upgrade potential
- Advocate wants to build relationship as a top 50 account

For additional information on how to select a High Value Account in Salesforce please reference the Account Review Doc FY26

### Engaging with Global Digital SMB Accounts

Since all Global Digital & SMB Accounts are owned by generic SMB Sales Users, SMB Advocates will only engage with customers when specific customer events / scenarios are triggered. Once one of these defined scenarios is triggered, a case will automatically be created. An SMB Advocate will then be assigned to it, and work it through to completion.

For additional information on how our case routing system works please reference the SMB Traction User Guide

### Why?

- Enables Advocates to focus on those SMB customers that require, or would benefit from, sales assistance.
- Removes low potential customers from view, since these customers will seldom trigger a case.

### How?

Cases are automatically created when;

- A customer requires sales assistance in order to transact.
- There is a high likelihood a customer will churn / contract.
- There is a high likelihood that a customer is considering upgrading or adding additional products.
- If none of the above apply, and the customer is on auto renew, a case will generally NOT be created.

### Case Types

Instructions and resources for working each case type can be found in the content below:

FY26 HVS Case Workflow Guide

FY26 SMB Case Enablement

FY26 SMB Case Triggers

### Working with the Global Digital SMB Account Team

If a GitLab team member needs to loop in the Advocate team on a customer Account, they must create a case. (Chatter messages sent to the AMER/ APJ/ EMEA Sales Users are not monitored).

## Case Creation How-to Video FY26 SMB/SDR Handover Process

- Navigate to the end user Account in Salesforce.
- Hover over Cases, and select New Case.
- Select SMB Sales Case, from the Record Type dropdown.
- Add the Contact, to the Contact Name lookup field. (A Lead can also be added, instead of a Contact, however in this scenario, the Account the Lead is matched to must also be manually added to the case. To find the matched account, view the Traction Complete Leads: Account field)
- Add the Opportunity, to the Opportunity lookup field (if relevant).
- Describe the ask of the AE in the case Description box. Include any relevant links or resources. (Once the case has been created, you can also upload files e.g. a PO, in the Google Docs & Attachments section at the bottom of the case record).
- Select a Type that most closely matches the origin of your request. (e.g if you are in Support, select Inbound Request)
- Set the Priority to High.
- Complete the Subject field, using one of the below options;
  - Support Ticket (if you are an SE)
  - Partner Opp (if you reside in the Partner org)
  - Referral (if you are in Sales)
  - FO Opp (Startup) if you reside in the Community relation team, and a free customer is ready to transition to paid.
  - AR Request (if you are in AR/ Billing)
- Note: if you are an SDR creating the case, the Case Subject must be either equal FO Opp, or SDR Created (See Use Case Specifics below)
- SDR must create a case with the Subject: FO Opp. Note: Please ensure the Account includes a complete Billing Address prior to setting the Record Owner to the AMER/EMEA/APJ Sales User in the Lead conversion screen.
- This Case will now routed and worked by an SMB Advocate.
- If a case has not been actioned as per the stated SLA, please chatter the regions ASM on the case to escalate.

### Tracking Cases you have created

Once you have created a case, you can easily view its progress by using the report below as a template.

### FY26 - Cases created by Department X

- Click Customize on the report.
- Click Edit next to the Created by filter.
- Enter in your name in the free text box. (You can also add the names of your colleagues who will also be creating cases. The names must be comma separated).
- Click OK
- Click Save As
- Choose a relevant name for the report, and save it in your teams folder.

You can now return to this report at any time to check;

- Who the current case owner is. They can be chattered on the case should you have any questions.
- Case Status (This should be either Open, In Progress, or Closed)
- Next Steps (Useful if the case is still set to In Progress)

## SMB Advocate Playbook

### Introduction to SMB Cases

- As of 02/01/2025, all cases will be auto-assigned to Advocates using Traction Complete's round-robin functionality.
- Information pertaining to the case will be displayed in the Context, CTA & Description box.
- At any time, an SMB Advocate can view their cases by navigating to the My Cases list view in Salesforce.

### Case Status

#### Available Case Statuses:

- Open
  - In Progress: Attempting Contact
  - In Progress: Blocked
  - In Progress: Engaged
  - Closed: Duplicate
  - Closed: Unresponsive
  - Closed: Resolved
- Once a Case is considered closed, the Status should be set to one of the three Closed options above and the Resolution Action updated. This will automatically update the Date/ Time Closed field.
- Note: Inbound customer requests must only be marked as closed once the customers needs have been addressed.

### Case Workflow and Management

- To work the case, the SMB Advocate should contact the customer, with all activities logged on the contact/ account, via Groove. The Next Steps fields on the case should also be updated to include the case next steps/ date.
  - An Advocate must then update the Status to In Progress (this shows the case is being worked).

#### Next Steps Field Hygiene Example:

- Incorrect: Contact
- Correct: 2024-07-05 KK First touch email to discuss promo
- Incorrect: Waiting on billing
- Correct: 2024-07-05 KK Followed up with billing team to approve refund request
- When working cases, the following Groove cadence should be followed.

- Day 1 - Email
- Day 3 - Call
- Day 5 - Email
- Day 7 - Email

- Note: When assigned a case created by a GitLab stakeholder e.g the Support Team, it is crucial that the Advocate updates Next Steps as soon as the case has been actioned.

This allows the stakeholder to view case updates, and negates the need for them to chatter the Case Owner requesting an update. Any updates that are requested via chatter, should be answered by the Advocate/ Case Owner within one business day.

- (If the Advocate is working on an Expansion Opportunity case, any Add On or Growth opp they uncover should be manually created, and linked to the case in question, via the Opportunity lookup field).

- If applicable, the linked opportunity should also be closed.

### Case Status and Action Required

### FY26 HVS Case Workflow Guide

### Common SMB Cases and Expected Outcomes

### FY26 HVS Case Workflow Guide

### GitLab Sales Rep Pre-Engagement Checklist

- Account Verification
- Additional Large Account Verification
- Account Data Validation
- Account Ownership Considerations
- Request Support

### Cross-Team Collaboration

When and how to engage with cross-functional teams:

### FY26 HVS Case Workflow Guide

### Resources & Tools

- FY26: GDS Case Enablement
- FY26 HVS Dashboards
- HVS Sales Tech Stack

### Advocate Expectations

- An Advocate should look to resolve/ close a case within 7 days of it being opened. The max time to resolve a case is limited to 15 days (List of case exceptions below).

- High Value Account
- Renewal Will Fail
- PO Required
- First Order (FO)



- Customer request to get in touch at a later date
- The Advocate must also adhere to the Required 10, to ensure that the correct case fields and opportunity fields are updated when picking up, working, and closing out a case.

## Renewals Team

The SMB Renewals Team will soft launch on May 5th, 2025. Every SMB Renewal opportunity will have a Renewal Manager attached and engaged.

- As the Renewals team ramps to full capacity, they will start to take over cases on accounts that are both < 3k CARR and < 20 LAM
- Most Renewals case types will be deprecated as soon as the Renewals teams take over renewal engagement.
  - Exceptions:
    - Autorenewal Recently Turned Off
    - Overage with QSR Off
    - Autorenewal Will Fail
- Renewal Managers can escalate cases to Advocates by adding advocate to the Subject of any case assigned to them
- These cases will be assigned as per usual SMB Advocate routing rules. Advocates can reach out to the RM for additional context.
- Renewals Managers will be assigned to HVA renewals, the expectation is for Advocates and RMs to work as a team to build these relationships
- As a reminder, please review recent Activities on your HVA accounts once RMs are engaged as that is where you will find their activities. They will also have access to and review your Account Plans.

## New Logo Team Playbook

Key Audience: New Logo Account Executive, Area Sales Managers, and Renewals Managers

## Introduction to New Logo Team

### Overview

The New Logo Team is a specialized sales team within GitLab's High Velocity Sales & New Logo organization focused on closing first-order deals in MM & ENT accounts.

### Team Structure

- Team Members: 4 New Logo AEs, 4 BDRs, and 1 ASM
- Launch Date: May 1, 2025

### Team Mission

- We are the painters of GitLab's unified DevSecOps vision, guiding prospects on transformative journeys to accelerate business results and the value they deliver to their customers.
- We are the architects of GitLab's future growth, planting the seeds today that will flourish for decades to come. Every new logo we secure today becomes tomorrow's expansion opportunity and advocacy story.

## Team Vision

- Gold Standard. We will build a New Logo flywheel that other teams and companies will study and attempt to replicate
- Talent Engine. We will have a legendary sales team that will be known for unmatched sales skill, a team that delivers insane amount of Logos, all while having fun and innovating.
- Value Accelerators. We are trusted partners who create transformative outcomes for our customers.
- Culture Champions. We are a showcase of GitLab's culture. Interacting with us is flexible, asynchronous enabled, and transparent.

## Team Values

- Relentless Prospecting. We are Pipeline Builders; no silver spoons. Prospecting happens every day, picking up the phone happens every day; no exceptions.
- Work Hard, Work smart. We leverage tools to get better. We are AI-powered. We make data-driven decisions.
- Hone our Craft. We are continuous learners - every day, we get 1% better. Be curious.
- Technical Command. We build deep understanding of our platform, speak DevSecOps fluently and bring value to technical buyers; we don't sell.
- Builder Mentality. Motion Architects, not quota chasers. We're building the playbook others will follow.
- Better Together. We overshare, your breakthrough belongs to the team. Isolation is the enemy of innovation. One team, one pipeline, one mission, one collective team intelligence.

## New Logo Sales Process

### Account Strategy

We use a tiered approach to focus efforts efficiently:

- Tier 1: High-priority accounts receiving most attention from BDRs and AEs, including collaborative prospecting
- Tier 2: Accounts receiving scaled outreach programs and targeted campaigns based on buying intent signals
- Tier 3: Accounts primarily receiving digital marketing and PLG motions rather than dedicated sales resources

### New Logo AE Time Allocation

Recommended Time Split:

- 40% Prospecting: Account strategy & planning and direct outreach
- 30% Deal Advancement: Moving opportunities through pipeline
- 20% Admin/Operations: CRM updates, forecasting, internal meetings
- 10% Feedback/Improvement: Process iteration and sharing learnings

A typical week should look like:

Monday: Strategy & Account Planning

- Team stand-up and weekly planning (30 min)
- Account planning and targeting strategy (2 hours)
- BDR collaboration sessions (2 hours)
- "Inbound Interest Feed" dashboard review (1.5 hours)

Tuesday & Wednesday: Prospecting & Deal Advancement

- Dedicated prospecting blocks (2.5 hours)
- Discovery and qualification calls (2 hours)
- Opportunity advancement (1.5 hours)

Thursday: Deal Advancement & Process Improvement

- SA engagement and technical validation calls (2.5 hours)
- Deal negotiation and proposal writing (1.5 hours)
- Team feedback session (1 hour)

Friday: Administrative & Closing

- Final push on deals closing this week (1.5 hours)
- CRM updates and opportunity management (1 hour)
- Internal meetings and enablement (1 hour)
- 1:1 with manager (1 hour)
- Weekly metrics review and forecast update (1 hour)

Success Metrics

Primary Metric (North Star)

- FO Count

Secondary Metrics

- Calls / touches (including LinkedIn and emails)
- Multi-threaded accounts (accounts where you're in touch with multiple people)
- Meetings
- Pipeline generation
- nARR
- Close Rate
- Average deal size and cycle time

Feedback Mechanisms

We actively seek and act on feedback across multiple channels:

How We Capture Feedback

- In Meetings/Slack: Weekly meetings and Slack channels for real-time feedback (focus on "1 thing we need to do differently to win")
- Passively: Gong reporting with weekly/monthly review cycles

- Active-ish: Feedback Friday form with specific questions
- Actively: Mechanisms to collect feedback during the sales cycle

#### Feedback Prioritization

- High Priority: Critical issues requiring immediate action
- Medium Priority: Selected items (3 per quarter) for potential development
- Low Priority: Ideas requiring additional data

#### Team Cadence

- Weekly: New Logo Team Meeting, 1:1 with Manager, 1:1 with BDR
- Monthly: HVS Team All Hands, Feedback/team learning sessions
- As needed: Additional collaboration sessions

#### Cross-Team Collaboration

#### BDR Collaboration

Each New Logo AE pairs 1:1 with a BDR handling both inbound and outbound motions. New Logo AE and BDR pairs will jointly target accounts and different personas with the account.

#### Account Selection

- Regular joint meetings to select target accounts
- Focus on Tier 1 accounts
- AEs can nominate accounts for BDRs to move into their "actively working account" list

#### Role Specialization

- BDRs typically focus on lower-level personas; AEs on higher-level contacts
- BDRs may cc AEs on executive outreach for credibility
- BDRs handle all MQLs until they become SAOs
- BDRs will target 4 new accounts per day (20 per week) with a 3 week prospecting cycle per account

#### Meeting Collaboration

- Inbound leads: BDRs qualify and may participate in the second discovery call with AEs
- Outbound efforts: BDRs and AEs can "tag-team" the first call with prospects

#### BDR Success Metrics

- Primary: 8 SAOs per month (target for fully ramped BDR). However, BDRs have a stretch goal to hit 10 SAOs per month with accelerators.

#### SA Collaboration

A First Order SME SA is aligned to this team to provide technical support during the sales process.

## When to Engage SAs

- When prospects are demo-ready: for customers wanting to understand GitLab's value and how it solves their business needs
- During Stage 3 for opportunities where a Command Plan and MEDDPIC documentation are being leveraged
- During technical evaluations: aim to have SAs involved at least 15 days of the Close Date and at least 1 day (ideally more) when direct engagement is needed

## SA Engagement Process

- AE completes Command Plan and MEDDPIC documentation
- AE submits SA request via SFDC with required information
- Request reviewed and assigned within one business day
- SA and AE align on strategy
- SA prepares customized materials
- SA supports technical aspects
- SA documents outcomes and next steps
- SA remains available for ongoing support

## Partner Collaboration

Our team will work with relevant GitLab partners to expand our reach and provide additional service capabilities to customers.

## Partner Motions

- With Rank 1 and Rank 2 accounts, partners will provide services and act as technical support especially if we have SA-capacity constraints. Examples:
  - Demos, VPs, and POCs
  - Co-selling with AWS
- For Unranked accounts, partners that also have contacts in our accounts will take the lead on the account as the primary sales contact

## Resources & Tools

### Essential Dashboards

- Inbound Interest Dashboard
- Free to Paid Cockpit
- New Logo Team Dashboard

### Key Documents

- FY26 HVS New Logo Playbook
- Base Account Selling Motion Strategy
- BDR Collaboration

This handbook page is a living document and will be updated as our team evolves. For questions or suggestions, please contact the New Logo Team ASM.

## Required 10

The Required 10 acts as a to do list which should be followed by all Advocates when picking up and working cases.

### FY26: SMB Required 10

#### Picking Up

##### Case: Status

- Should be set to In Progress, (then Closed - Resolved/ Duplicate/ Unresponsive once worked).
- "Waiting" statuses can be used to indicate a dependency on a business partner team.

##### Case: Owner

- Should always be set to the Advocate working the case. Cases can be moved in rare circumstances i.e the end user wishes to converse in a language that you do not speak, but another Advocate does.

##### Case: Contact

- Advocate to add/update the main contact, as the case is being worked. If a lead exists on the case, it must be converted to a Contact before the case is closed out.
- A case cannot be set to Closed Resolved unless a Contact is attached to the case.

#### Managing

##### Case: Next Steps & Date

- To act in the same fashion as Opp: Next Steps. Field is mandatory.
- Format must be; Date, Advocate Initials, What the Next Step is
- - 2024-07-12 MS Send quote to customer

##### Account: GitLab Admin added

- Only for cases related to an opportunity
- Must be added in order to move opp to closed won.

##### Related Opportunity

- If the case involves an open opportunity, it should be linked to case in this field.

##### Opp: Close Date

- Only for cases related to an opportunity
- To help with forecasting. Must not be in the past.

##### Opp: Renewal Risk Category

- Only for cases related to an opportunity
- To help with forecasting
- If an opportunity is marked as guaranteed churn, please remember to set the stage to Closed Lost

#### Contact/ Account: Activity

- Must be logged via Groove on the Contact

#### Closing

#### Case: Resolution Action

- Mandatory when closing out a case.

#### Opp: Status

- Only for cases related to an opportunity
- To mimic the case i.e if the case is closed, the opp should be closed won or lost

#### Case: Feedback

- A place where an Advocate can share feedback pertaining to the case itself, or the customers use case. This is mandatory. If there is no Feedback to share, NA should be entered in this field. Next Steps and general comments should not be listed in this field - feedback only.
- e.g Customer Feedback : ·thank you for helping me resolve my problem very quickly·

#### Case Closure Criteria

##### Closed - Resolved

- The Advocate was able to address the customers' concern/ transact the renewal, and no further action is needed. A case cannot be marked as Closed - Resolved if the Next Steps Date is in the future, and/ or the Contact field on the case is blank.

##### Closed - Duplicate

- An Advocate has already addressed the customer's concern via a similar case.

##### Closed - Unresponsive

- After 15 days of trying to contact the end user, no response have been received.

#### Use Case Specifics

#### Email to Case

SMB customers are able to email [smallbusiness@](mailto:smallbusiness@) in order to speak to an Advocate.

When they do so, an SMB Case will automatically be created and will be routed to an Advocate in AMER/EMEA/APJ.

The subject of the email will be displayed in the Case Subject field, and the email body will appear in the Case Description field.

## FAQ

Q. As an Advocate, if I am assigned a case, but there is no contact/ account/ lead attached to the case - how do I know if the case falls into my region?

A. If a customer emails smallbusiness@ and they do not exist in Salesforce as a contact, the contact and account fields will not be populated on the case. When this happens, we have no way of knowing which region the customer resides in.

Traction will attempt to match the person to a Contact or Lead using the Web Email field. If that fails, SMB Ops will be notified to determine where the case should be routed.

Q. If a case is routed to me, but the customer continues to email smallbusiness@, how will I know?

A. Once you have been assigned a case, any future emails from the customer in the same thread will trigger a notification to be sent to the case owner. All emails in the thread are also attached to the case.

Q. If a customer has a new request, but they send an email to smallbusiness@ via an old thread, will a new case be created?

A. No. Unfortunately, the email will be attached to the prior case which is likely to have been closed. In this scenario, the owner of the prior closed case (who will receive a notification of the customer's email), should either ask the customer to initiate a new request (by sending a new email to smallbusiness@. This will create a new case, and start a new thread. Or, the Advocate can create a new case on the customer's behalf, and work that case.

## High Value Account Cases

Whilst Accounts are always owned by the regions SMB Sales User, High Value Account Cases attached to accounts are owned by the SMB Advocate.

These cases are to remain open for the entirety of the FY26, even if the customer renews. This means that if a HVA customer renews mid way during FY26, they will be assisted by the same Advocate both pre and post renewal.

These cases act as a reminder that these customers require continual attention and should be worked strategically during the financial year.

The Advocate is advised to build relationships with these customers, understand their journey with GitLab, and identify what we can do to grow the account (Ultimate or Add On licenses) or promote adoption and churn prevention.



The Advocate is advised to schedule ongoing touchpoints, update Next Steps/ Next Steps Date, and create future dated reminder Tasks, so that they plan their outreach throughout the year.

Note that these Accounts will still trigger other cases types, which should be worked and closed out within the 15 day period. Any opp created off the back of these cases i.e If a High Value Check In Case results in an Add On Opp, the opp should be linked to the originating case. Once the opp is closed, the case should be closed. Reminder: The High Value Account case should never be closed.

Note: A High Value Account can be closed out if the customer advises ahead of renewal that they definitely fully churn. Only in this scenario should the case be closed out, and the Resolution Action must be set to Request Not Possible. By setting the Resolution Action to Request Not Possible, future High Value Cases will not be created on the account.

For more information about managing HVA cases over the year, please review this FY26 SMB Account Planning slide

FO Opp (an SDR engages with a net new lead who has been qualified)

Before picking up the case, the Advocate checks that they can attend the meeting (IQM) that appears as an Activity on the Contact record, and in the Next Steps fields. The SDR will be able to see that the case has routed to the Advocate assigned in the IQM.

The below SDR Handover Process steps, and Handover Criteria, detailed below should also be followed by both the SDR and Advocate.

Note: If Prospect is ready to buy (i.e no IQM is required), does not qualify for Advocate support, and is unable to purchase their license via Web (Ex: Multi-Year, Needs PO, Duo Pro, etc), please proceed with the Blocked Purchase Workflow. Criteria here.

SDR Created (an SDR engages with a lead that is related to a customer account)

Before creating a case, the SDR should convert the lead to a contact, under the customer account.

When creating the case, this newly created Contact should be added to the Case.

The below SDR Handover Process steps, and Handover Criteria, detailed below should also be followed by both the SDR and Advocate.

FY26 SDR Handover Process

FO Opp Case Example

SDR Created Case Example

The above examples can be used as templates for when an SDR creates a case.

Support Cases

When an Advocate picks up a support case, and the case contains a link to a Zendesk ticket, they must comment in the Zendesk ticket advising that they have picked up the case, and will be

reaching out to the customer.

### Customer MQL Cases

Whilst working the case, the lead on the case should either be;

- Converted to a contact under the linked account, if the lead confirms they work at the linked account/ company, AND there is an nARR opportunity.
- Not converted/ disqualified if the lead does not work at the linked account/ company, OR there is no nARR opportunity.

### Expansion Opportunities

If an opportunity is uncovered whilst working an Expansion Opportunity case, a new Growth/ Add On opp should be created, and linked to the case via the Opportunity lookup field. An Add On opp must be created from the prior closed won renewal opp that exists on the account.

If the customer is looking to upgrade to Ultimate/ add users at the time of renewal, the existing Renewal opp should be linked to the case. The renewal opp should also be used for any new quotes that are generated.

### Case Hygiene

### Case SLA

All cases should be picked up and reviewed within 24 hours of being routed and assigned.

### Open Case Guidelines

All cases should be worked, and closed out, within a 15 day period (except High Value Account cases).

The above, and other data points, will be tracked on the below dash. Periodically, the info will be presented to the Advocate so that they can 'clean up their room'.

Due to the high case volume, it is imperative that the Required 10 is followed, so cases do not become stale.

### Case Resolution Action Dictionary

- Answered Question
- Recommended Resource
- Transferred To Support
- Growth Conversation
- Directed to Online Purchase
- Completed Sales Assisted Order
- Request Not Possible
- No Action Required
- Failed to Engage

### Dashboards, Reports & Enablement Docs

- SMB Advocate Scorecard (AMER/ EMEA)
- SMB Advocate - Run Your Day Dash
- SMB Large Deal Management
- FY26 SMB Individual nARR Crediting ROE
- SMB Traction User Guide
- SMB Ops Changelog
- FY26 SMB Dashboards
- SMB Sales Tech Stack
- GitLab Sales Rep Pre-Engagement Checklist

## FAQ

- Q. Will cases be assigned to me everyday?
- A. Yes, we expect new cases to be created daily, and to total approximately 400 per month.
- Q. Can I pick up any Case in the queue?
- A. No, cases will now be routed via Traction and the queue is no longer used. Any case considered a High Value Account will be routed to the corresponding Advocate.
- Q. How many cases should I work at any give time?
- A. An Advocate should only own 50 In Progress cases at a time. Once at 50, the Advocate is deemed to be at capacity.
- Q. Where can I provide feedback on this model/ process?
- A. Please submit all feedback via the hvs slack channel. If you want to share Feedback relating to a specific case, please enter the feedback in the Case: Feedback field.
- Q. Is additional enablement material available?
- A. Yes, please see the Dashboards, Reports & Enablement Docs section of this page.
- Q. As a GitLab Team Member who is not part of the SMB Team, how do I engage with the team?
- A. Follow the process above entitled Working with the Global Digital SMB Account Team.
- Q. What happens if the end user speaks a different language than I do?
- A. Discuss with your manager who might be best placed in the team to handle this case, then switch the Case Owner to that individual. Also add the tag languagebarrier to the Feedback field on the case. This will allow the SMB Team to track how often language becomes an issue.
- Q. As an Advocate, if I am assigned a FO Opp case, and discover the customer is actually a MM account, what do I do?
- A. Follow the below steps;
  - If the FO Opp is still in Stage 0, advise the SDR via Chatter that they should loop in the MM AE.
  - Mark the case as Closed - Duplicate
  - If the IQM has taken place, and you have moved the opp to Stage 1, loop in the relevant MM AE on the opp, via Chatter.
  - Closed the case as Closed - Duplicate.
- Q. There is no opportunity linked to the case, but I have identified a Growth/ Add On opportunity, what do I do?
- A. If you discover a Growth opportunity, you should manually create a Growth/ Add On opp and link it to the case via the Opportunity field. If an opp is already attached to the case (Renewal or QSR opp), this opp should be updated to reflect the possible growth.
- Q. If I am working a case, and the customer advises they are looking to expand but not for 6 months, should I close out the case?
- A. No, update the Next Steps stating that the customer is open to a conversation in 6 months. Also, change the Next Steps Date to 6 months from todays date, and update the stage of the case to Open. Please remember to leave the open case in your name.

- Q. I am an AE not in the SMB Org, and a former customer has reached out to me. This customer is now owned by an SMB Sales User. How do I hand this customer over to the SMB Sales Team?
- A. Follow this process.
- Q. I just closed won on opp for a SMB Customer, which took them above the \$30k CARR threshold. How do I hand this over to MM?
- A. See this doc. Note that accounts will be moved to MM at the start of the next quarter.
- Q. When I am working a case, and the customer is interested in speaking in 6 months, do I keep the case open, or close it out?
- A. In this scenario, the case should remain open and left in your name. To do this;
  - Update the Next Steps on the case, as per your conversation with the customer.
  - Set to Next Steps Date to 6 months from today.
  - Set the Case Status to Open
- Q. If a prospect/ customer emails me directly requesting assistance, what do I do?
- A. First check the account to see if there is an In Progress SMB Sales Case owned by a different Advocate. If there is, add the nature of the customers request to the Description field, and chatter the Advocate on the case. If no case is present, and this enquiry represents a nARR opportunity, follow the above process (Working with the Global Digital SMB Account Team.), and assign the case directly to yourself. Note: for general enquiries, you should direct customers to [smallbusiness@gitlab.com](mailto:smallbusiness@gitlab.com)
- Q. As an Advocate, when I go on PTO, what happens to my cases?
- A. Whilst on PTO, your In Progress cases will remain in your name. In your OOO email signature however, you should include the contact details of a fellow Advocate who has agreed to cover you whilst you are away. Ideally, this Advocate should be located in a similar region with similar language skills. When a customer emails you (and the Advocate providing coverage), the Advocate providing coverage should assign the active case to themselves, and work it through to completion. Also, be sure to follow the standard PTO guideline stated here.

## Escalation Paths

## Solutions Architect

An Advocate should talk to their Manager to determine if SA support is necessary and available.

## Support

Loop in [supportteam@gitlab.com](mailto:supportteam@gitlab.com), and set the Resolution Action of the current open case to Transferred to Support.

## Transitioning Accounts to Mid-Market / Enterprise

Chatter Sales Support, advising that the account in question may need to be re routed to the correct team.

## SMB Advocate Onboarding + Enablement

## By Case-Type

## First Order

- Propensity to Purchase - Deck

- Propensity to Purchase - Training
- Doing a great discovery call

#### Expansion/Upgrade

- Propensity to Expand
- PTE & PTC Scores Walkthrough Video
- Creating a great Ultimate Pitch - INTERNAL ONLY

#### Churn/Contraction Mitigation

- Propensity to Contract/Churn
- PTE & PTC Scores Walkthrough Video

#### Renewal and TRX Support

- Overview of Renewals at GitLab (internal handbook, log in via SSO)

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## SECTION: sales/commercial/hvs\_fo\_feedback.md

#### Background

Currently the HVS team derives feedback from SFDC Cases via Advocates, Customer self-cancels on CDot, and periodic CSAT/NPS surveys. We want to centralize all these sources, ensure we are getting the best version of the respective feedback, and actioning on them to the best of our abilities. Below is a guide on our best practices surrounding this effort.

#### Feedback sources

##### Case feedback

When an Advocate closes a case, they select their Feedback Type and add comments in the Feedback field surrounding said case. This feedback can range from case logic, product, to customer experience feedback. See this case where you can navigate to the Feedback and Feedback Type fields for an example.

##### Portal cancels

When a customer self-cancels on the Customers Portal, they are prompted to select a cancel reason and add additional comments in the text field. The HVS team can access this data to derive insights. See this screenshot of the cancel prompt.

##### Customer call recordings or emails

Advocates can record customer calls on Gong and can screenshot any relevant customer email they receive. This can be posted on our hvs channel. HVS Leadership will also periodically review Gong call recordings to aggregate any product-related feedback.

Ad-hoc hvs channel posts

Any other type of feedback is typically posed in this feedback Slack channel.

CSAT/NPS

Company-wide CSAT Survey